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Lost in Epstein's Web
REVIEW

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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DOW JONES News Corp ***** SATURDAY/SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 7 - 8, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 31 [WSJ.com](https://www.wsj.com) ★★★★★ \$6.00

What's News

Business & Finance

- The Dow hit 50000** for the first time, the latest milestone in a yearslong run. The index soared 1,206.95 points, or 2.5%, on Friday, while the S&P 500 and Nasdaq jumped 2% and 2.2%, respectively. **A1, B11**
- Uber was ordered** to pay \$8.5 million in compensatory damages after a jury found the company liable for the 2023 sexual assault of a 19-year-old passenger. **A3**
- Toyota's CEO** is stepping down after a relatively short term in office that was buffeted by Trump's tariffs and struggles to maintain market share in China. **B9**
- Jeep maker Stellantis** said it would book charges of about \$26 billion, the latest automaker to flush out massive investments in EVs. **B9**
- Under Armour expects** revenue to fall at the milder end of its fiscal 2026 forecast. **B10**
- SpaceX has put off** a mission to Mars planned for this year, shifting its focus to a long-promised lunar voyage for NASA in March 2027. **B9**
- Once Upon a Farm**, the organic children's food maker, made its debut on the New York Stock Exchange, rising 17%. **B11**

Worldwide

- The Justice Department** is investigating whether Netflix has engaged in anticompetitive tactics as it probes the streaming giant's proposed acquisition of Warner Discovery's studios and HBO Max streaming service. **A1**
- Trump posted**—and later deleted—a video online that included imagery depicting former President Obama and Michelle Obama as apes, prompting bipartisan condemnation. **A1**
- The administration's** immigration crackdown—and the push to arrest demonstrators—is straining U.S. attorneys' offices across the country. **A3**
- Iran stuck** to its refusal to end enrichment of nuclear fuel in talks with the U.S., but both sides signaled a willingness to keep working toward a diplomatic solution. **A7**
- A federal judge** ordered the Trump administration to temporarily unfreeze funding for a \$16 billion rail tunnel under the Hudson River. **A6**
- A row has broken out** between the U.S. and Poland after it emerged that a leading Polish official refused to sign up to a lobbying effort to get Trump awarded the Nobel Peace Prize. **A7**

PEGGY NOONAN
A lament for the Washington Post **A15**

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Dow Hits 50000 for the First Time

Bets on U.S. growth help power rally's latest stages but warning signs remain

By DAVID UBERTI

The Dow Jones Industrial Average hit 50000 for the first time on Friday, the latest milestone in a yearslong run

in which the U.S. economy has muscled past its rich peers and snapped up investment the world over. Since the blue-chip index plunged below 6600 during the depths of the 2007-09 recession, it has effectively moved in one direction on the flickering screens of Wall Street: up and to the right. Bouts of trading turmoil that periodically upended the Dow

now seem like speed bumps in the U.S.'s rearview mirror. An era of ultralow interest rates helped spur the longest postwar expansion in U.S. history and pump Silicon Valley into a global juggernaut. Washington threw massive amounts of money into the financial system and economy to propel a rapid rebound from the pandemic. An artificial-intelligence boom has

more recently juiced the stock market at a historic scale. The Dow's final push above 50000 arrived at an unlikely moment. As Wall Street has ramped up scrutiny of AI mania, and a slump in software stocks began spilling into other areas of the market in recent days, investors have funneled money into real-economy stocks in a wager that the U.S.'s growth is once

again accelerating. "We don't think that the U.S. opportunity is over by any stretch of the imagination," said Chris Hyzy, chief investment officer of Bank of America Private Bank and Merrill. *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Exchange: AI tears through Corporate America..... B1**
◆ **The road to Dow 50000 was perilous..... B11**

Italy Makes a Splash to Open the Winter Olympics



LET THE GAMES BEGIN: Three giant paint tubes are seen Friday at a performance during the Opening Ceremony of the Milan Cortina Winter Olympics, which included tributes to artists, composers, designers and other icons of Italian culture. **A12**

Goldman Lawyer Kept Ties to Epstein Till End

By ANNA MARIA ANDRIOTIS AND BEN GLICKMAN

The night Jeffrey Epstein was arrested, on July 6, 2019, he called three people. One of them was Kathryn Ruemmler. A handwritten set of notes from law enforcement released by the Justice Department lists a call to Ruemmler's cellphone that was placed at 7:15 p.m. The

notes, jotted on blank pages, also include comments Epstein made inside the FBI vehicle and while in custody, after he was picked up at New Jersey's Teterboro Airport. *Please turn to page A6*

◆ **Epstein emails cost top lawyer his job..... A4**
◆ **Epstein was intermediary for Bill Gates, adviser..... A4**

Trump Deletes Post Of Obamas as Apes

WASHINGTON—President Trump posted—and later deleted—a video online that in-

By Natalie Andrews, Ken Thomas and Anvee Bhutani

cluded imagery depicting former President Barack Obama and Michelle Obama as apes, prompt-

ing swift condemnation from Democrats and Republicans. The video was deleted late Friday morning, after the White House initially defended it, following calls from lawmakers of both parties to remove it. The White House blamed a staffer for posting the video. The roughly one-minute *Please turn to page A6*

DOJ Casts Wide Net On Netflix In Review Of Merger

By JESSICA TOONKEL AND DAVE MICHAELS

The Justice Department is investigating whether Netflix has engaged in anticompetitive tactics as it probes the streaming giant's proposed acquisition of Warner Discovery's studios and HBO Max streaming service, according to a civil subpoena viewed by The Wall Street Journal. Questioning how Netflix competes with rivals suggests the department is looking at whether its planned Warner deal could entrench its market power, or lead to a monopoly in the future. U.S. law gives enforcers broad power to oppose mergers that could lead to a monopoly. "Describe any other exclusionary conduct on the part of Netflix that would reasonably appear capable of entrenching market or monopoly power," the agency asked in the subpoena, sent to another entertainment company. Netflix agreed in December to pay \$27.75 a share in cash in a deal totaling \$72 billion. Paramount has made a rival \$77.9 billion hostile bid for all of Warner Discovery including its cable-networks unit that houses CNN, TNT, Food Network and other channels. The Justice Department is also reviewing Paramount's *Please turn to page A6*

Mongolians In Cashmere Strike Gold

* * *

Athletes conquer Opening Ceremony with warrior duds

By BEN COHEN AND JOSHUA ROBINSON

MILAN—Team USA was dressed by Ralph Lauren, Canada came decked out in the finest Lululemon and Italy welcomed the world to the Milan Cortina Games in uniforms designed by Emporio Armani. But the most stylish delegation in this global capital of fashion was the one wearing a cashmere collection inspired by warriors on horseback, nomads in yurts and the strength of history's most sprawling empire. *Benvenuti...Mongolia! Please turn to page A11*

Japan Leader Seeks Tighter U.S. Alliance

The prime minister bets her seat in an election Sunday to cement her power

By JASON DOUGLAS AND JUNKO FUKUTOME

TOKYO—Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi wore a black-leather jacket and rode a motorcycle to her admissions interview at an elite training academy for aspiring leaders four decades ago. The 20-something daughter of a factory worker, who played drums in a heavy-metal band, wore a crisp suit under her biker jacket. In her interview, she declared with beaming confidence a goal of entering politics, a field still dominated in Japan by wealthy sons of famous dynasties. "I got the impression that

she was someone who would carve out her own destiny," recalled Masato Homma, who sat in on Takaichi's interview when he was a senior at the Matsushita Institute of Government and Management. Now, after carving a path to the summit of Japanese politics, Takaichi is wagering her prime minister's seat in an election Sunday she hopes will cement her power and help fulfill her vision of building a stronger Japan that is an indispensable ally to the U.S. Takaichi says she will *Please turn to page A11*

◆ **Youth set to propel prime minister in election..... A10**



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